
Component 3: Poetry

Overview

Students will study a selection of poems from two published poetry texts.

They will consider the concerns and choices of modern-day poets in a selection of contemporary poems. Students will apply their knowledge of poetic form, content and meaning, and develop their skills in comparing an unseen poem with an example of studied poetry.

Students will also develop depth of knowledge about poetic style by studying a selection from the work of a single named poet, *or* a selection from within a literary period or movement. Literary study of the chosen set poems should be enhanced by study of the contexts in which they were written and received.

Learning outcomes

Students are required to:

- show knowledge and understanding of the function of genre features and conventions in poetry
- show knowledge and understanding of a range of ways to read texts, including reading for detail of how writers use and adapt language, form and structure in texts, responding critically and creatively
- show knowledge and understanding of a range of literary texts and make connections and explore the relationships between texts
- show knowledge and understanding of the ways texts can be grouped and compared to inform interpretation
- show knowledge and understanding of the contexts in which texts have been produced and received and understanding of how these contexts influence meaning
- communicate fluently, accurately and effectively their knowledge, understanding and critical evaluation of texts
- identify and explore how attitudes and values are expressed in texts
- use literary critical concepts and terminology with understanding and discrimination
- make appropriate use of the conventions of writing in literary studies referring accurately and appropriately to texts and sources.

Content

In this component, students will study aspects of a range of poetry, from the established literary canon through to the present day.

Students are required to study two selections of poetry; one specified post-2000 poetry text **and** either one specified selection of poems from one pre- or post-1900 text. This will be either a single named poet or a literary movement.

The lists of poems to be studied can be found in *Appendix 5: Prescribed texts*.

Post-2000 poetry

Specified text:

Poems of the Decade: An Anthology of the Forward Books of Poetry 2002–2011

Specified Poetry Pre- or Post-1900

Centres choose **either** selected poems from the **named text** or the single **named poet** from the following periods:

Pre-1900 choices

The Medieval Period

Medieval Poetic Drama

OR

Medieval Poet: Geoffrey Chaucer

Metaphysical Poetry

The Metaphysical Poets

OR

Metaphysical Poet: John Donne

The Romantic Period

The Romantics

OR

Romantic Poet: John Keats

The Victorian Period

The Victorians

OR

Victorian Poet: Christina Rossetti

Post-1900 choices

The Modernist Period

Modernism

OR

Modernist Poet: T S Eliot

The Movement

The Movement

OR

The Movement Poet: Philip Larkin

Unseen poetry

Students will be required to respond to an unseen poem in comparison with a studied poem from their contemporary text. Centres are welcome to make use of the additional poems in the contemporary text, that have not been set for study, for unseen practice and wider reading.

Pre-1900 requirement

If a pre-1900 choice is not selected as one of the poetry options then it must be selected in *either* Component 1: *Drama* or Component 2: *Prose*. Please see the *Qualification requirements* section on page 5 for more information on ensuring this requirement has been met.